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PSAC Exam Practice Platform — Specimen Paper

2026

History & Geography

Grade 6 — Primary School Achievement Certificate

Specimen Paper 4

Focus: Culture & Heritage of Mauritius • Population & Society

Duration: 1 hour 45 minutes **Total Marks:** 100

Candidate Name: _____

School: _____

Index Number: _____

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

1. Answer **ALL** questions in all sections.
2. Write your answers in the spaces provided.
3. This paper has **FOUR sections**: A, B, C and D.
4. Section A: Map Work and Population Geography — 25 marks
5. Section B: History of Mauritius (Culture & Heritage) — 35 marks
6. Section C: Geography of Mauritius (Population & Society) — 25 marks
7. Section D: Civics, National Symbols and Heritage — 15 marks
8. Read each question carefully before answering.
9. Marks for each question are shown in brackets [].
10. Do not open this booklet until you are told to do so.

SECTION A — MAP WORK AND POPULATION GEOGRAPHY [25 marks]

1. Study the population density map of Mauritius below and answer the questions that follow.

[13]

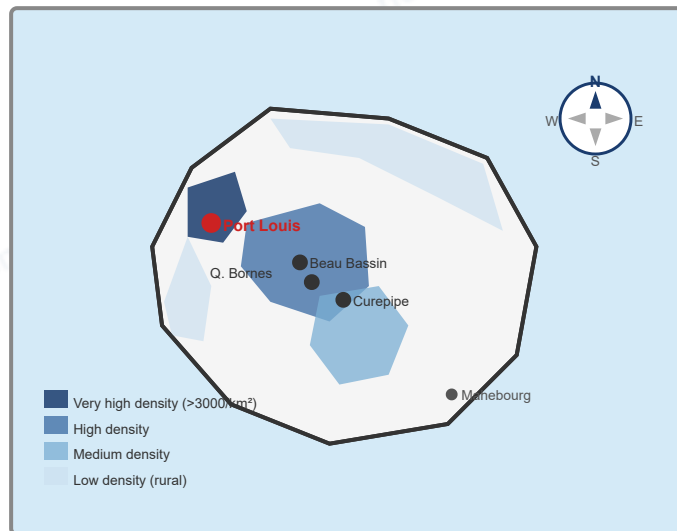


Fig. 4 — Population density map of Mauritius (simplified)

- (a) Which area of Mauritius has the highest population density according to the map? [1]

- (b) Which parts of Mauritius are least densely populated? [1]

- (c) Name **four** towns or cities that form the densely populated central urban belt. [2]

- (d) Give **two** reasons why Port Louis has such a high population density. [2]

- (e) Give **two** reasons why the rural north and east of Mauritius have a lower population density. [2]

- (f) What is "population density"? Give the formula used to calculate it. [2]

- (g) The total population of Mauritius is approximately 1,300,000 and the area is 2,040 km². Calculate the average population density of Mauritius. Show your working. [2]

- (h) Tick ONE correct answer. Mauritius is considered to be: [1]

- ☐ A A very sparsely populated island (less than 50 people per km²)
- ☐ B One of the most densely populated countries in the world
- ☐ C An uninhabited island
- ☐ D Less populated than France

2. Answer the following questions about the Indian Ocean region and Mauritius's neighbours.

[12]

- (a) Name the island that is a dependency of Mauritius and is located about 600 km to the east. [1]

- (b) Name the French island that is a close neighbour of Mauritius (about 200 km to the west). [1]

- (c) Name the African mainland country closest to Mauritius. Approximately how far is the African coast from Mauritius? [2]

- (d) Describe the location of Mauritius using compass directions and geographical terms (ocean, hemisphere, tropics). [3]

- (e) What is the Tropic of Capricorn? Is Mauritius north or south of it? What does this tell us about the climate? [3]

- (f) Name **one** organisation that Mauritius belongs to that groups African nations together. [1]

- (g) Give **one** advantage of Mauritius's island location in terms of trade. [1]

SECTION B — HISTORY: CULTURE AND HERITAGE OF MAURITIUS [35 marks]

3. Answer the following questions about the cultural heritage of Mauritius.

[14]

- (a) What does "multicultural" mean? Explain how Mauritius became a multicultural society. [3]

- (b) Name the **four** main ethnic / community groups that make up the population of Mauritius. [4]

- (c) Match each festival to the community that celebrates it. [4]

Festival	Community (write A, B, C or D)
Diwali (Festival of Lights)	
Eid-ul-Fitr	
Chinese Spring Festival (New Year)	
Christmas	

A = Muslim community **B** = Hindu community **C** = Christian community **D** = Sino-Mauritian community

- (d) What does the phrase "Unity in Diversity" mean in the context of Mauritius? Give **one** example of how different communities live and celebrate together. [3]

4. Answer the following questions about UNESCO World Heritage Sites and historical heritage in Mauritius.

[13]

- (a) What is UNESCO? What does it do for world heritage? [2]

- (b) Read Source A carefully and answer the questions below. [5]

Source A: Le Morne Cultural Landscape

"Le Morne Brabant is a rugged mountain on the south-west peninsula of Mauritius. During the period of slavery (18th and early 19th century), it was used as a refuge by Maroon communities — enslaved people who had escaped their captivity and sought freedom in its caves and forests. The landscape is a symbol of the resistance against slavery and of the suffering of enslaved people. When UNESCO inscribed it as a World Heritage Site in 2008, it recognised Le Morne as an outstanding symbol of human courage in the struggle for freedom. A tragic legend tells of Maroons who jumped from the cliff in 1835, not knowing that slavery had just been abolished and that the soldiers climbing the mountain had come to bring them the news of freedom."

- (i) Where is Le Morne Brabant located in Mauritius? [1]

- (ii) According to Source A, why did enslaved people use Le Morne Brabant as a refuge? [1]

- (iii) In which year was Le Morne inscribed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site? [1]

- (iv) Describe the "tragic legend" mentioned in Source A. Why does this legend make Le Morne especially significant? [2]

- (c) Name the other UNESCO World Heritage Site of Mauritius. In which year was it inscribed? Why is it important? [3]

- (d) Name **two** other historical sites or buildings in Mauritius that are of historical importance (not UNESCO World Heritage Sites). [2]

- (e) Tick ONE correct answer. What is the significance of Pointe-aux-Canonniers? [1]

- ☐ A It is where the first Dutch settlers arrived
- ☐ B It is the site of a military fort built during the British period
- ☐ C It is the highest mountain in Mauritius
- ☐ D It is the location of the first sugar mill

5. Answer the following questions about languages, arts and the cultural life of Mauritius.

[8]

- (a) What is Kreol Morisien (Mauritian Creole)? How did it develop? [2]

- (b) What language is used for official purposes and in government in Mauritius? [1]

- (c) Name **two** traditional art forms or crafts of Mauritius. [2]

- (d) Sega is the traditional music and dance of Mauritius. Describe sega briefly. Which community is it most closely associated with, and what are its origins? [3]

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SECTION C — GEOGRAPHY OF MAURITIUS: POPULATION AND SOCIETY [25 marks]

6. Answer the following questions about the population of Mauritius.

[14]

(a) Study the population data below and answer the questions. [5]

Year	Population	% Urban	Life expectancy (years)
1968	780,000	43%	61
1990	1,058,000	54%	69
2024	1,300,000	60%	75

Table 2 — Population statistics for Mauritius

(i) By how much did the population of Mauritius increase between 1968 and 2024? [1]

(ii) How has the percentage of urban population changed? What does this trend tell us? [2]

(iii) Life expectancy has increased from 61 to 75 years. Give **two** reasons for this increase. [2]

(b) What does "urbanisation" mean? Give **two** causes of urbanisation in Mauritius. [3]

(c) Give **two** problems that can arise when too many people move to cities (urban problems). [2]

- (d) What is an "ageing population"? Give **one** challenge this presents for Mauritius. [2]

7. Answer the following questions about education, health and living standards in Mauritius. [11]

- (a) Is primary education free in Mauritius? Up to which level is education free? [2]

- (b) What is the PSAC? What does it stand for? When do students sit this examination? [3]

- (c) Read Source B and answer the questions below. [4]

Source B: Living standards in Mauritius

"Mauritius ranks among the highest in Africa on the United Nations Human Development Index (HDI), which measures life expectancy, education and income. Access to clean water and sanitation is nearly universal. Healthcare is free to all citizens. Literacy rates are high, with over 90% of adults able to read and write. However, inequality remains a challenge — the gap between the richest and poorest households is significant. The government has introduced social welfare programmes to help the most vulnerable citizens."

- (i) Name the index mentioned in Source B that measures quality of life. What three things does it measure? [2]

- (ii) According to Source B, what percentage of adults in Mauritius can read and write? [1]

(iii) What challenge does Source B say still exists in Mauritius? [1]

(d) Give **two** ways in which the Mauritian government helps its citizens who are in need. [2]

SECTION D — CIVICS, NATIONAL SYMBOLS AND HERITAGE [15 marks]

8. Answer the following questions about national symbols and heritage. [9]

(a) Complete the table of national symbols of Mauritius. [5]

National Symbol	Answer
National flag colours (in order, top to bottom)	
National anthem	
National bird (extinct, but still the national symbol)	
National flower	
National motto (in Latin)	

(b) The coat of arms of Mauritius shows four symbols in four quarters. Name **two** of these symbols and briefly state what each represents. [2]

(c) What is Independence Day and why is it celebrated on 12 March? [2]

9. Answer the following questions about rights, responsibilities and citizenship. [6]

(a) Give **two** responsibilities of a good citizen of Mauritius. [2]

- (b) What is the Equal Opportunities Commission in Mauritius? Why was it set up? [2]

- (c) **Extended response:** Explain what it means to live in a multicultural society. What are the benefits of Mauritius's diverse cultures? Give **three** examples in your answer. [2]

End of Paper 4 — Check your work before handing in. Total: 100 marks.

Mark Scheme — Specimen Paper 4 (2026)

For teacher / parent use only. Accept any reasonable answer that demonstrates correct understanding. Where multiple acceptable answers exist, any correct answer earns the mark. Award marks generously for responses showing clear understanding.

Q	Answer	Marks
1(a)	Port Louis / the northwest of the island	1
1(b)	Rural north and east / coastal areas away from main towns / the south-west	1
1(c)	Any four: Port Louis; Beau Bassin; Rose-Hill; Quatre Bornes; Curepipe; Vacoas-Phoenix (1 each; accept 2 marks for all four correct)	2
1(d)	Any two: capital city and commercial centre (1); port and employment (1); historical development as the main city (1)	2
1(e)	Any two: land used for sugar cane / farming (1); fewer services and jobs than in towns (1); less developed infrastructure (1)	2
1(f)	Population density = number of people per unit area (1); Formula: $\text{Population} \div \text{Area (km}^2\text{)} = \text{people per km}^2$ (1)	2
1(g)	$1,300,000 \div 2,040 \approx 637$ people per km^2 (1 for correct method, 1 for answer in range 630–640)	2
1(h)	B — One of the most densely populated countries in the world	1
2(a)	Rodrigues	1
2(b)	Réunion (La Réunion)	1
2(c)	Madagascar (1); approximately 900 km (accept 800–1000 km) (1)	2
2(d)	Mauritius is an island in the Indian Ocean (1); in the southern hemisphere (1); approximately 20 degrees south of the equator; east of Madagascar and Africa (1)	3
2(e)	The Tropic of Capricorn is the line of latitude at 23.5°S marking the southernmost point where the sun can be directly overhead (1); Mauritius is just north of it (1); this means Mauritius has a tropical climate with warm temperatures year-round (1)	3
2(f)	Any one: African Union (AU); SADC (Southern African Development Community); COMESA; Indian Ocean Commission (IOC)	1
2(g)	Any one: strategic position on shipping routes between Asia, Africa and Europe; access to large Exclusive Economic Zone; trade with nearby countries	1
3(a)	Multicultural = having many different cultures/ethnic groups/religions living together (1); Mauritius became multicultural because of colonisation — the Dutch, French and British brought enslaved people from Africa and Madagascar,	3

Q	Answer	Marks
	and indentured labourers from India and China, all of whom settled on the island (2)	
3(b)	Any four: Hindu (Indo-Mauritians); Muslim (Indo-Mauritian / Muslim community); Creole (African/Malagasy descent); Sino-Mauritian (Chinese community); General Population (European/mixed descent) — accept any four recognised communities (1 each)	4
3(c)	Diwali — B (Hindu); Eid-ul-Fitr — A (Muslim); Chinese Spring Festival — D (Sino-Mauritian); Christmas — C (Christian). 1 mark each	4
3(d)	"Unity in Diversity" means that different communities live harmoniously together despite their cultural differences (1); any example: Mauritians of different faiths celebrate each other's festivals; all communities celebrate Independence Day together; different foods, music and traditions are shared nationally (1+1)	3
4(a)	UNESCO = United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (1); it identifies and protects sites of outstanding universal value to humanity (1)	2
4(b) (i)	South-west peninsula of Mauritius	1
4(b) (ii)	It had caves and forests / it was a rugged, inaccessible place where it was safe to hide	1
4(b) (iii)	2008	1
4(b) (iv)	Maroons jumped from the cliff believing soldiers were coming to recapture them — not knowing slavery had just been abolished (1); it symbolises the ultimate sacrifice made in the name of freedom / makes the site a place of deep sadness and meaning (1)	2
4(c)	Aapravasi Ghat (1); 2006 (1); it is the landing point of indentured labourers / represents one of the most significant mass migrations in modern history (1)	3
4(d)	Any two: Château de Labourdonnais; Eureka House; Martello Towers; Fort Adelaïde; Mahebourg Naval Museum; Natural History Museum; Mahebourg Historical Monument (1 each)	2
4(e)	B — It is the site of a military fort built during the British period	1
5(a)	Kreol Morisien (Mauritian Creole) is a French-based creole language that developed as a common language for people of different origins to communicate (1); it developed during slavery when enslaved Africans and Malagasy people mixed French with their own languages (1)	2
5(b)	English	1
5(c)	Any two: sega music/dance; weaving; pottery; model ship building; painting; embroidery; sculpture (1 each)	2
5(d)	Sega is a lively traditional music and dance (1); most closely associated with the Creole community (African/Malagasy descent) (1); its origins lie in the culture of enslaved people who used music and dance as a form of expression and resistance (1)	3

Q	Answer	Marks
6(a) (i)	1,300,000 – 780,000 = 520,000 increase	1
6(a) (ii)	It increased from 43% to 60% (1); this shows increasing urbanisation — more people moving to towns and cities (1)	2
6(a) (iii)	Any two: better healthcare / free health service; better nutrition; improved sanitation / clean water; medical advances / vaccines; better education (1 each)	2
6(b)	Urbanisation = the movement of people from rural areas to towns and cities (1); any two causes: search for jobs (1); better services and education in towns (1); decline of sugar industry / farming (1)	3
6(c)	Any two: overcrowding; traffic congestion; strain on housing / homelessness; pressure on water and electricity supplies; pollution; crime (1 each)	2
6(d)	An ageing population = more elderly people and fewer young people (1); challenge: higher cost of pensions and healthcare; fewer workers to support the economy; labour shortages (any 1 clear challenge)	2
7(a)	Yes, primary education is free (1); education is free and compulsory up to secondary level / Form V (SC level) (1)	2
7(b)	PSAC = Primary School Achievement Certificate (1); it is the national examination taken at the end of Grade 6 (1); sat at the end of Grade 6 primary school / around age 11-12 (1)	3
7(c) (i)	HDI = Human Development Index (1); it measures life expectancy, education/literacy, and income/standard of living (1)	2
7(c) (ii)	Over 90%	1
7(c) (iii)	Inequality / the gap between richest and poorest households	1
7(d)	Any two: social welfare payments; free healthcare; free education; social housing; disability allowance; old-age pension (1 each)	2
8(a) table	Flag: Red, Blue, Yellow, Green (1); Anthem: Motherland / "Motherland" (1); Bird: Dodo (1); Flower: Boucle d'Oreille / Trochetia boutoniana (1); Motto: Stella Clavisque Maris Indici (1)	5
8(b)	Any two: ship (trade/seafaring) (1); key / Star and Key (strategic importance as Star and Key of Indian Ocean) (1); dodo (1); sugarcane (1); deer (1); palm tree (1). Accept any two symbols + meanings from the actual Mauritian coat of arms.	2
8(c)	Independence Day is a national holiday (1); celebrated on 12 March because Mauritius became independent from Britain on 12 March 1968 (1)	2
9(a)	Any two: obey the law; vote in elections; pay taxes; respect others' rights and cultures; protect the environment; serve in the community (1 each)	2

Q	Answer	Marks
9(b)	The Equal Opportunities Commission is an independent body that protects people from discrimination (1); it was set up to ensure all citizens are treated equally regardless of race, religion, gender or social background (1)	2
9(c)	2 marks for extended response: living in a multicultural society means sharing a country with people of different backgrounds, religions and traditions (1). Benefits and examples: cultural richness (food, music, festivals); different skills and knowledge; tolerance and understanding; economic diversity (award 1 mark for any three relevant examples or well-reasoned points)	2

Total: 100 marks • Nouklass.com Specimen Paper 4 (2026) • Not an official MES document.